

MODULE 00 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

How this course works

What the exam is, what changed in May 2026, and how to get the most out of the next fourteen hours.

DOMAIN All domains COURSE RUNTIME 14h 15m MODULE 00 of 36

Almost nobody fails this exam because they have never heard of a feature. They fail because three options all look correct, and only one respects **a constraint in the second sentence.**

The exam at a glance

From the official exam guide, version dated 4 May 2026

- ◆ **45 scored questions, 90 minutes.** Unscored trial questions are also included, unmarked, with extra time allowed for them.
- ◆ **Multiple choice, four options.** One answer per question.
- ◆ **USD 200** plus local tax. Online proctored or at a test centre. No test aids of any kind.
- ◆ **No prerequisite.** Databricks recommends course attendance and six months of hands-on use.
- ◆ **The pass mark is not published.** Ignore any site that quotes one as fact.

ON THE EXAM

Valid for two years. To recertify you take whatever the live exam is at that time, not the one you sat.

The seven domains

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	MODULES
Databricks Intelligence Platform	6%	01-02
Data Ingestion and Loading	21%	03-08
Data Transformation and Modeling	22%	09-15
Working with Lakeflow Jobs	16%	16-19
Implementing CI/CD	10%	20-22
Troubleshooting, Monitoring and Optimisation	10%	23-26
Governance and Security	15%	27-30

ON THE EXAM

Module minutes track these weights, bar optimisation, which runs long on purpose.

Where the fourteen hours go

PART OF THE COURSE	EXAM WEIGHT	RUNTIME
Domain 3 - Transform	22%	160 min
Domain 2 - Ingest	21%	147 min
Domain 4 - Jobs	16%	86 min
Domain 7 - Govern	15%	80 min
Domain 6 - Troubleshoot	10%	80 min
Domain 5 - CI/CD	10%	61 min
Domain 1 - Platform	6%	51 min
Revision and 3 practice exams	-	176 min

ON THE EXAM

Teaching time tracks the exam's own weighting. Domains 2 and 3 are 43% of the paper and get the most minutes.

A new version of this exam went live on **4 May 2026**. Most material in circulation, including almost every question bank, describes the version before it.

Four renames you will meet under two different names

WHAT IT WAS CALLED	WHAT IT IS CALLED NOW	WHEN
Databricks Asset Bundles	Declarative Automation Bundles	16 Mar 2026
Databricks Repos	Databricks Git Folders	2025
Delta Live Tables, or DLT	Lakeflow Spark Declarative Pipelines	2025-2026
Databricks Workflows	Lakeflow Jobs	2025

ON THE EXAM

All four renames are cosmetic. No code changes, no migration, and the DAB acronym survived the bundles rename intact.

What the old material teaches, and what the exam now asks

OVER-REPRESENTED IN OLDER BANKS

Still useful, no longer weighted

- Pipeline expectation syntax and ON VIOLATION
- The LIVE keyword and CREATE STREAMING LIVE TABLE
- Delta Sharing, shares and recipients
- Databricks Connect
- Dashboards and alerts as their own topic

BARELY PRESENT IN OLDER BANKS

A fifth of the current exam

- CI/CD, bundles, Git folders and the CLI
- Cluster startup failures, library conflicts, memory
- Unity Catalog ABAC and governed tags
- The DENY privilege
- Lakeflow Connect managed and standard connectors

WHY THIS MATTERS

Roughly one question in five now comes from the right-hand column. Older question banks will not prepare you for any of them.

How this course is built

- ◆ **Every scenario is original.** Nothing is copied from a question bank. Banks are recycled, often leaked, and memorising them trains recognition rather than reasoning.
- ◆ **Every explanation traces to Databricks documentation,** checked against the live docs rather than recalled.
- ◆ **Wrong answers get explained too.** Understanding why a distractor fails transfers to questions you have never seen.
- ◆ **Dates on anything that changed.** Where the exam and current reality differ, you get both.

ON THE EXAM

A question bank was used here, but only to measure which decisions get tested and how often. None of its questions appear.

The shape of a teaching module

01

The idea

One statement the whole module turns on.

02

The mechanics

How the feature works, and its real limits.

03

The tiebreaker

The rule that separates two options that both look right.

04

Scenarios

Four to eight worked decisions, option by option.

ON THE EXAM

The tiebreaker slides are the highest-value minutes in the course. They are what the exam is actually testing.

How to use the scenarios

This convention is the difference between watching and learning

- ◆ **Every scenario is two slides.** The situation and question, then the full walkthrough.
- ◆ **Pause on the first one and commit to an answer.** Say it aloud or write it down.
- ◆ **Watching a walkthrough without answering first teaches almost nothing.** Every explanation sounds obvious once you have heard it.
- ◆ **When you are wrong, find the sentence you missed** rather than memorising the answer.

ON THE EXAM

Being wrong on a scenario and understanding why is worth more than being right on three.

The last six modules

- ◆ **31 Confusion pairs.** Every pair of features that sound alike, side by side. Almost no new content, which is the point.
- ◆ **32 The naming migration.** Every rename with its date, so old study material stops being confusing.
- ◆ **33 How the exam is written.** Question anatomy, qualifier words, how to spend ninety minutes.
- ◆ **34, 35, 36 Practice exams.** Three papers of 25 questions, mixed across domains as the real exam mixes them.

ON THE EXAM

75 practice questions against a real paper of 45, weighted to the official domain percentages across the whole set. About two hours of the course.

Who this is for, and what to bring

- ◆ **Some SQL.** Joins, grouping, subqueries. You do not need to be fluent.
- ◆ **Enough Python to read it.** The exam shows PySpark; it does not ask you to write it from nothing.
- ◆ **Git as vocabulary.** Branch, commit, push, pull request. Not deep Git.
- ◆ **Not required:** machine learning, cluster administration, or prior Databricks certification.

ON THE EXAM

Databricks recommends six months of hands-on use. If you have none, expect to spend time in a free trial workspace alongside this course.

A study route that works

01

Watch in order

Modules build vocabulary. Later ones assume earlier ones.

02

Take exam 1

Under time. Note which domain the misses fall in.

03

Rewatch one domain

Only the weak one. Not the whole course.

04

Exams 2 and 3

Spaced a few days apart, not back to back.

05

Module 31 last

Confusion pairs the day before you sit.

ON THE EXAM

Which domain your misses cluster in tells you far more than the score does.

Three ways revision goes wrong

- ◆ **Rewatching what you already know.** It feels productive because the scores stay high, and it moves nothing.
- ◆ **Grinding a question bank.** You end up learning that bank. The exam will not show it to you.
- ◆ **Trusting a single source on anything that has a date.** Weights, names and features have all moved recently.
- ◆ **The fix for all three is the same.** Practise retrieving under time, then chase the misses.

ON THE EXAM

If a study session felt comfortable, it probably did not teach you anything.

Nothing on this exam is hard. Choosing between four things that all work, under time pressure, **is** hard. That is what the next fourteen hours are for.